commitment to inflation control stood above all else'. In its editorial, 'Central Bank Rerun', the *Indian Express*, dated 10 August 2011, wrote: 'In the next two years, apart from negotiating through the expected global uncertainty, Subbarao's biggest challenge will be to reorient the multi-instrument, multi-objective, non-accountable, non-transparent, RBI into a central bank that promises and delivers price stability. He has now been given another chance to change the RBI and help it fit the needs of a rapidly growing India.'

At the dinner table that evening, Urmila said to me, 'Now that you've got an extension, I suppose you can be more independent.' I was surprised by this statement-cum-question. I believed and continued to believe that standing by your conviction and doing what you think is right is more a matter of personality than opportunistic behaviour. I would be no less or no more independent, I told Urmila, than I had been in the first three years of my term.

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When I next ran into the media at some event, a reporter asked me: 'Are you reconciled to living in Mumbai for two more years?' Both the question and the way he phrased it surprised me. It struck me that the question was not the expected one about my challenges and goals for the next two years; nor was it about life in Mumbai. It was about being '*reconciled* to living in Mumbai'.

I figured out where he was coming from. In the early days of my shift from Delhi to Mumbai, I had felt distinctly uncomfortable. That had nothing to do with Mumbai, but with the sanitized life that the governor is expected to lead. I had lived and worked in Delhi for several years. I had gone around by bus, by auto and by car; I had walked the streets of Delhi. I was familiar with the city and felt comfortable in it. Although I had visited Mumbai dozens of times in the past, I had never lived there. Indeed, I couldn't recall staying in Mumbai more than three consecutive nights.